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Bulger poster at bar outrages neighbors

Dorchester restaurant, once owned by man he killed, got TV show makeover

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

The first thing patrons see when they walk into Savin Bar and Kitchen is a poster-sized mugshot of the late notorious South Boston gangster, James “Whitey” Bulger.

A mugshot of his partner in crime, Stephen “the Rifleman” Flemmi, hangs on another brick wall of the Dorchester restaurant.

The placement of the images was part of a restaurant makeover by celebrity chef Gordon Ramsay that was featured on a television series over the summer and intended to embrace the history of the building, according to Ken Osherow, co-owner of Savin Bar.

“We’re not hanging those images to celebrate them, but to recognize a chapter in the gritty story of our neighborhood,” Osherow said dur-



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

A mugshot of “Whitey” Bulger in Savin Bar and Kitchen.

ing a telephone interview, insisting they weren’t meant to glorify the gangsters. “We’re acknowledging the history of this very spot.”

But the mugshots have outraged neighbors who are demanding their removal, not only because Bulger and Flemmi killed people while running a sprawling criminal enterprise and secretly working as FBI informants. One of those victims was Edward Connors, who ran a tavern, Bulldogs, in the same spot that is now Savin Bar, when he was murdered decades ago.

BULGER, Page B4

As deal unfolds, anxiety, hope mix

Hostage release scheduled for Monday in Gaza Strip; Trump set to meet families

By Isabel Kershner
NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — Israelis and Palestinians prepared Sunday for an exchange of all of the living hostages still held in the Gaza Strip for about 2,000 Palestinians imprisoned in Israel, a cornerstone of a new cease-fire agreement.

The Israeli government said the exchange was expected to begin Monday morning local time, but Israel was prepared for it to happen sooner. Under the agreement, Israel is supposed to free the Palestinian prisoners — scores of them serving life terms for deadly attacks on Israelis — in parallel with the hostage releases.

“This is a historic event that blends sorrow over the release of murderers and joy over the return of hostages,” Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in a recorded statement broadcast Sunday evening.

On both sides, there was relief mixed with elation after two devastating years of war. Adding to the hope: The open-ended truce between Israel and Hamas, which was brokered by the United States and Arab mediators and began at noon Friday, appeared to be holding over the weekend.

President Trump left the United States on Sunday and was expected to land in Israel on Monday for a short visit. He is set to meet with the families of hostages and address the Israeli Knesset, or parliament, in Jerusalem.

He then is scheduled to fly to Sharm el-Sheikh, **MIDEAST, Page A6**



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Monet Eliastam dragged tires behind her at Singing Beach in Manchester-by-the-Sea, part of her training regimen.

N. SHORE TO S. POLE

Her journey to the bottom of Earth starts here, one tiresome step at a time

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

MANCHESTER-BY-THE-SEA — On a recent evening, Kassie Renard took a stroll to Singing Beach, and when she arrived at the sand’s edge, she saw her again — the woman with the tires.

She’s become a common sight in this and the surrounding towns on the North Shore, the woman slowly dragging two large tires — and lots of questions — behind her.

“The other day she was dragging them

on the street up the hill to the beach,” Renard said, “and I was like ‘What the hell is she doing?’”

Her name is Monet Eliastam and what she is doing is training to try to do something no American woman has done before.

In November, the 36-year-old will set off to attempt to cross-country ski to the South Pole, solo and unsupported. That means she’s got to lug 250 pounds of food and gear behind her on a sled for 700 miles, a journey that should take her about 50 days.

And she’s been dragging those two Jeep tires across beaches and through the woods all over the place, for several hours each day, for nearly three years.

So that’s *what* she’s doing.

But that always leads to the follow-up question, one she just got hit with by a woman in the Singing Beach parking lot as she was unloading the tires: *Why?*

The answer to that is more unexpected. It began a decade ago when she received a

TIRES, Page A7

Tariff uncertainty squeezes Mass. manufacturers

Cost of materials, changes in supply chain leave many in a production whirlpool

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

FALL RIVER — At a 19th-century cotton mill here, under an American flag hanging from the ceiling and not far from the old Honda motorbike at the door, workers at Vanson Leathers are designing, cutting, and stitching leather jackets. The jackets are cool enough to make a cameo at the Super Bowl half-time show, cool enough that the company describes motorcycle riders as its target customers.

The leather for the jackets comes mostly from upstate New York. But the textile materials are imported from India and sometimes China. The zippers come from a Japanese

company that has a plant in Georgia.

“We say, ‘Made in America of domestic and imported materials,’” said Mike van der Sleenen, Vanson’s cofounder and president.

These days, that means tariffs have raised his costs and made selling his high-end jackets abroad harder.

Almost nine months into President Trump’s effort to make sure more goods are made in the United States, businesses that are already making things here are trapped in a dizzying gyre of uncertainty. With the Supreme Court set to decide whether many Trump tariffs are le-

TARIFFS, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Employee Emilio Rodriguez worked on the factory floor of the Matouk Factory, a linen manufacturer based in Fall River.

At MGB, the doctor is artificially in

Use of AI to help address dire shortages frustrates some in primary care

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Mass General Brigham has turned to artificial intelligence to address a critical shortage of primary care doctors, launching an AI app that questions patients, reviews medical records, and produces a list of potential diagnoses.

Called “Care Connect,” the platform was launched on Sept. 9 for the 15,000 MGB patients without a primary care doctor. A chatbot that is available 24/7 interviews the patient, then sets up a telehealth appointment with a physician in as little as half an hour. MGB is among the first health care systems nationally to roll out the app.

Several primary care doctors at MGB, however, described AI as a sideshow, a distraction from what they contend is the real solution to the shortage: providing the pay and working conditions that will attract more primary care physicians to the state’s largest health system and keep them from leaving.

They also expressed misgivings after MGB told **MGB, Page A10**

‘It’s like your local . . . restaurant getting replaced by a vending machine.’

MICHAEL BARNETT, a BWH primary care doctor



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

The ocean blew

Monday: Heavy rains. High 56-61, low 51-56.

Tuesday: Rain ends early. High 55-60, low 49-54.

High tide: 4:45, 5:00.

Sunrise: 6:55. Sunset: 6:05.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **B6.**

Vice President JD Vance warned that the longer the government shutdown goes on, the more furloughs will be turned into firings. A2.

Boston road officials are experimenting with a new kind of barrier to separate bikes and motor vehicles. B1.

Visitors from England were booted from a Boston area concert after they couldn’t prove they were of legal

drinking age. The couple are 64 and 70. **D1.**

Madagascar’s president said an elite army division had joined students in an attempted coup. A4.

The Patriots (including Mack Hollins and Drake Maye at right) won their third straight game, overcoming some sloppy play to defeat the New Orleans Saints, 25-19, on the road. C1.

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